Using a ***Risk Graph***

Guidelines for determining the level of risk

To decide on what level of risk arises from a hazard, you have to think about:

- the likelihood of an incident and
- the potential effect or severity of an incident.

The **likelihood** can be decided on a scale of 1 to 5.

1. Highly unlikely: not known to occur.
2. Remote possibility: known to occur.
3. Occasional: has happened before.
4. Fairly frequent, some occurrences.
5. Frequent occurrences.

The potential effect or **severity** can also be decided on a scale of 1 to 5.

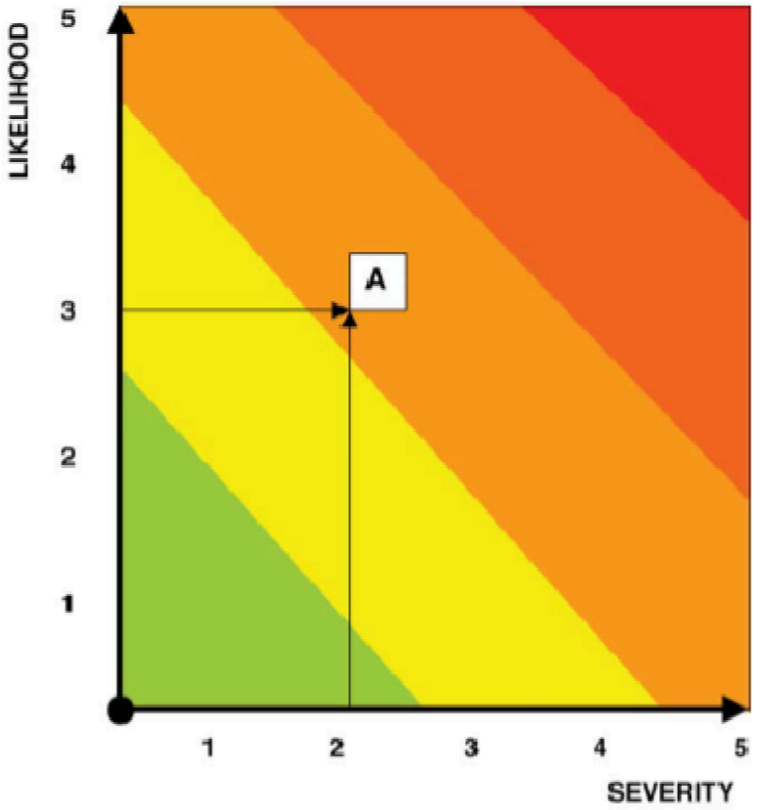
1. Minor injury.
2. Over three day injury.
3. Temporary incapacity/disease.
4. Permanent incapacity.
5. Fatality.

Action to be taken

The level of risk that you identify will decide what action should be taken:

Level of risk	Action to be taken
Very high risk	Stop activity. Take immediate action.
High risk	Take action the same day.
Medium risk	Take action within one week.
Low risk	Monitor the situation.
Insignificant risk	No action required.

You use the numbers from these ***two factors*** to draw ***horizontal*** and ***vertical lines*** on the ***risk graph*** shown opposite. You will find the ***level of risk*** where the ***two lines cross***.



Example A shows an accident that occasionally happens (**Likelihood number 3**) resulting in an over-three-day injury (**Severity number 2**).

Where the lines cross is identified as a **Medium risk** and action should be taken within one week.